

Akhil Paul

Product Design Leader · B2B SaaS & Consumer · 0→1, AI & Design Systems

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SUMMARY

Product design leader with 10 years taking B2B SaaS and consumer products from 0→1 to scale. At Birdeye (100,000+ business customers), I lead design for five product areas and the Aero design system; at Phenom, I grew from Product Designer to Manager and helped scale the chatbot business from zero to \$10M in revenue. Hands-on: I build production-like prototypes with Claude, Cursor and Grok, and partner closely with executives, Product and Engineering.

EXPERIENCE

Manager, Product Design · Birdeye

Aug 2023 – Present

Joined as Staff Product Designer; promoted to Manager. Named 2025 Bar Raiser (top 1% of employees).

- Lead design for five product areas (Platform, Integrations, Insights, Reporting, Marketing Automation), managing a team of up to 5 designers and partnering with Product and Engineering leaders on roadmap.
- Led Insights 2.0, a ground-up rebuild of enterprise reputation analytics benchmarked against Sprinklr and Reputation; drove the revamp-vs-refresh call through 4 executive reviews and introduced the Experience Score. Product grew from \$0 to \$5M ARR in 18 months.
- Directed the Competitor Benchmarking redesign across Setup, Insights, Reviews and Social with 3 lead designers, 3 PMs and ~22 engineers; replaced manual setup with auto-fetched competitors to fix low adoption and package it as an Insights upsell.
- Leading design of a new Marketing Automation suite (2 designers) targeting \$5M ARR by Q4 2026, designed around a first campaign in under 10 minutes.
- Lead the Aero design system across a 14-designer org, setting shared standards for consistency and delivery speed.
- Designed AI experiences, including agent recommendations and AI search, and co-led the design team's AI transformation and adoption.

Manager, Product Experience (Chatbots & Scheduling) · Phenom

Jun 2017 – Aug 2023

Promoted three times in six years, from Product Designer to Manager, Product Experience.

- Built the career-site chatbot and its self-service management platform from 0→1 as design lead, helping scale the chatbot business unit from zero to \$10M in revenue and 100K+ weekly users.
- Raised chatbot engagement from 0.02% to 7% of career-site traffic (350×) by moving from a passive FAQ widget to a proactive, jobs-first conversational flow, which increased both lead volume and lead quality.
- Designed self-service bot configuration that removed support-ticket-driven onboarding, where adding FAQs alone took 3+ weeks.
- Led design of Talent Companion, the chatbot unit's flagship paid Gen AI product (AI-generated FAQs, SMS/email candidate guidance), launched at IAMPHENOM 2023.
- Led a team of up to 5 designers on Scheduling and CRM; after the MyAlly acquisition, redesigned interview scheduling from research with 5 customers and validated it with 6 recruiters.
- Shaped product strategy in regular innovation sessions with the CEO; led research and design for Swaasa, an India-focused blue-collar gig-hiring concept.

Senior UI/UX Designer · GrabOn

Sep 2016 – May 2017

- Led redesigns of HappySale, BestPriceOn and Sellers Commerce; built a customer feedback mechanism that increased feedback visibility 20×.

EARLY WORK & PROJECTS

Adobe: Master's thesis, Photoshop Elements for touch · IIT Guwahati: UX for an urban-planning research tool · Freelance: Algo Engines, Nawab House, Bloomin Salons · Side project: AI Figma plugin that validates copy against style guides

SKILLS

Leadership Design strategy · Team building & mentoring · Executive partnership · Cross-functional leadership

Craft 0→1 product design · Data visualisation · Conversational & Gen AI UX · Design systems · User research

Tools Claude, Cursor & Grok for production-like, high-fidelity prototypes · Figma (incl. plugin development)

EDUCATION

Masters in Design, User Experience Design, MIT Institute of Design, Pune

2014 – 2016

B.E., Electronics & Telecommunication Engineering, University of Mumbai

2008 – 2013